INCH-POUND

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January 11, 2024
SUPERSEDING
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COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BRAID, TEXTILE, CORD-EDGE

The General Services Administration has authorized use of this Commercial Item Description (CID) for all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE. The cord-edge textile braid (cord-edge) is intended for use on garrison caps worn by military personnel of the Departments of the Army ,the Air Force, and the Space Force.

2. CLASSIFICATION. The cord-edge shall be available in the following classes, as specified.

2.1 Classes.

Class 1 – Gold-colored metalized yarn cord cover with Heritage Green flat braid
Class 2 – Gold-colored metalized yarn and black yarn cord cover with Heritage Green flat braid
Class 3 – Silver-gray yarn and black yarn cord cover with Heritage Green flat braid
Class 4 – Heritage green cord cover with Heritage Green flat braid
Class 5 – Aluminum-colored metalized yarn cord cover with Air Force Blue flat braid
Class 6 – Aluminum-colored metalized yarn and Air Force Blue yarn cord cover with Air Force Blue flat braid
Class 7 – Air Force Blue cord cover with Air Force Blue flat braid
Class 8 – Gold-colored metalized film and black yarn cord cover with Heritage Green flat braid
Class 9 – Aluminum-colored metalized film and black yarn cord cover with Heritage Green flat braid
Class 10 – Aluminum-colored metalized film cord cover with Air Force Blue flat braid
Class 11 – Aluminum-colored metalized film and Air Force Blue yarn cord cover with Air Force Blue flat braid

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FSC 8315

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Class 12 – Aluminum-colored metalized yarn cord cover with Space Force Dark Navy flat braid
Class 13 – Aluminum-colored metalized yarn and Air Force Blue yarn cord cover with Space Force Dark Navy flat braid
Class 14 - Space Force Dark Navy cord cover with Navy flat braid

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Description. The cord-edge consists of a flat braid section (see 3.4.1) and a cord section (see 3.4.2) braided together. The cord section shall consist of a cord cover (see 3.4.2.1) braided around a cotton core (see 3.4.2.2). The color of the cord cover and flat braid sections shall be in accordance with the class (see 2.1 and Tables I and IV).

3.2 Material.

3.2.1 Cotton yarn. The yarns used for the core section of all classes shall be carded cotton yarns. The core shall be unbleached or white.

3.2.2 Polyester yarn. The non-metallic portions of the cord covers and flat braid shall be a semi-dull multifilament, nominal 150 denier (17 Tex) heat set, texturized polyester yarn.

3.2.3 Metallic portions of cord covers. Classes 1 and 2 cord-edge shall use gold-colored metalized yarn (see 3.2.3.1.1) for metallic portions. Classes 5, 6, 12, and 13 shall use aluminum-colored metalized yarn (see 3.2.3.2.1) for metallic portions. Classes 8 through 11 shall use laminate film of the appropriate color (see 3.2.3.1.2 or 3.2.3.2.2) for metallic portions.

3.2.3.1 Gold-colored.

3.2.3.1.1 Gold-colored metalized yarn. The gold-colored metalized yarn used for the cover of Class 1 and 2 cord-edge shall be a polyester yarn wrapped with a metalized film that shall be good match to Goldenlite HG (cable color 67107) in color.

3.2.3.1.2 Gold-colored metalized film. The gold-colored film used for metallic portions of the cover of the Class 8 cord-edge shall be a polyester film that is one-sided metalized with aluminum and treated to provide a gold color that shall be a good match to the standard sample (see 7.4). Film shall be 1/32-inch wide.

3.2.3.2 Aluminum-colored.

3.2.3.2.1 Aluminum-colored metalized yarn. The aluminum-colored metalized yarn used for the cover of the Classes 5, 6, 12, and 13 cord-edge shall be a polyester yarn wrapped in a film that is metalized to be aluminum that shall be a good match to the standard sample (see 7.4) in color.

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3.2.3.2.2 Aluminum-colored metalized film. The aluminum-colored metalized film used for metallic portions of the cover of the Class 9, 10 and 11, cord-edge shall be a polyester film that is one-sided metalized with aluminum and treated to provide an aluminum color that shall be a good match to the standard sample (see 7.4). Film shall be 1/32-inch wide.

3.3 Color. The color shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

3.3.1 Visual shade matching. The color of the polyester yarns, metalized yarns and metalized foils shall be a good match to the standard samples of the colors specified in Table I (see 7.5). The color shall be evaluated using AATCC EP 9, Option C, (see 7.5.1) with a primary light source simulating the spectral quality of average daylight, CIE Illuminant D65, with a color temperature of 6500 (± 200) Kelvin (K) illumination of 100 (± 20) foot candles. Alternatively, the color and appearance of the polyester yarns, metalized yarns and metalized foils shall match the standard sample with a primary light source simulating artificial daylight, CIE Illuminant D75, with a color temperature of 7500K (± 200) illumination of 100 (± 20) foot candles in lieu of D65. (See 7.5.2). The polyester yarns, metalized yarns and metalized foils shall also be a good match to the standard sample with a secondary source simulating the spectral quality of incandescent lamplight, CIE Illuminant A, with a color temperature of 2856K (± 200).

TABLE I. Colors for finished cord-edge.

Class	Cord Cover	Flat Braid Section
1	Gold-colored metalized yarn Goldenlite HG (cable number 67107)	Heritage Green 564
2	Gold-colored metalized yarn Goldenlite HG (cable number 67107), and Black polyester yarn (Cable number 65018)	Heritage Green 564
3	Silver-gray polyester yarn (cable number 65008), and Black polyester yarn (cable number 65018)	Heritage Green 564
4	Heritage Green 564 polyester yarn	Heritage Green 564
5	Aluminum-colored metalized yarn	Air Force Blue 1611
6	Aluminum-colored metalized yarn and Air Force Blue 1611 polyester yarn	Air Force Blue 1611
7	Air Force Blue 1611 polyester yarn	Air Force Blue 1611
8	Gold-colored metalized film and Black polyester yarn Cable number 65018	Heritage Green 564
9	Aluminum-colored metalized film and Black polyester yarn Cable number 65018	Heritage Green 564
10	Aluminum-colored metalized film	Air Force Blue 1611
11	Aluminum-colored metalized film and Air Force Blue 1611 polyester yarn	Air Force Blue 1611
12	Aluminum-colored metalized yarn	Space Force Dark Navy 1690
13	Aluminum-colored metalized yarn and Air Force Blue 1611 polyester yarn	Space Force Dark Navy 1690
14	Space Force Dark Navy 1690 polyester yarn	Space Force Dark Navy 1690

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3.3.2 Colorfastness. The dyed braid shall meet colorfastness requirements as specified in Table II. During the testing cited, cord-edge shall show no evidence of degradation, delamination or fraying.

TABLE II. Colorfastness test methods.

Colorfastness to:	Rating	Test Procedure
Perspiration (Color Change and Staining) (min.)	4	AATCC TM15 1/, 2/
Wet Dry Cleaning (3 cycles) (Color Change) (min.)	4	AATCC TM132 1/
Light (after 40 AFU 3/ or 170 kJ/(m^2nm) @ 420 nm) (min.)	4	AATCC TM16.3 1/
Crocking Dry/Wet (min.)	4.0	AATCC TM8 4/ 5/

1/ Rated using the AATCC EP1, Gray Scale for Color Change
2/ Rated using the AATCC EP2, Gray Scale for Staining
3/ AFU: AATCC Fading Units
4/ The lengths of the cord-edge shall be laid so that the cord portions are side-by-side, presenting the same continuous height.
5/ Rated using the AATCC EP8, AATCC 9-Step Chromatic Transference Scale.

3.4 Construction.

3.4.1 Flat braid section. The flat braid section for all classes shall be braided over 2, under 2 with polyester yarn, with the finished braid conforming to the requirements of Table III.

TABLE III. Flat braid section requirements.

Flat braid section	All Classes	Test Method
Width per inches	1/4 – 5/16	Calibrated ruler or micrometer
Number of carriers (minimum) 1/	25	Visual
Ends per carrier (minimum) 1/	3	Visual
Picks per inch 2/	26	Visual
Warp ends for 25 carrier braider	11-2 ends up	Visual
Lines for 25 carrier braider (minimum) 1/	6	Visual

1/ One (1) determination per sample unit and results shall be reported as “actual count.”
2/ Three (3) determinations per sample unit and the results shall be reported as “pass”or “fail.”

3.4.2 Cord section. The cord section shall consist of a cord cover braided around a cotton core (see 3.4.4). The width of the finished cord section shall be 3/32-inch to1/8-inch. The cover shall conform to the requirements of Table IV.

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3.4.2.1 Cord cover. The cord cover for all classes shall consist of 19 carriers, with end count per carrier as specified in Table IV. There shall be a minimum of 26 picks per inch, with three determinations per sample unit and the results reported as “pass” or “fail.” Braiding shall be “over 2, under 2” for all classes of cord-edge, making one determination per sample unit and the results reported as “pass” or “fail.” For the ends per carrier counts in Table IV, there shall be one determination per sample unit and results shall be reported as “actual count.” All ends per carrier counts are with ends up.

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TABLE IV. Cord cover ends per carrier (minimum) requirements.

Yarn/Foil	Classes													
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
Polyester yarn, 150 denier Heritage Green	---	---	---	19-4---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---
Polyester yarn, 150 denier Black	---	14-2	14-4	---	---	---	---	14-2	14-2			---	---	---
Polyester yarn, 150 denier Silver-Gray	---	---	5-4	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---
Polyester yarn, 150 denier Air Force Blue	---	---	---	---	---	14-2	19-4	---	---	---	14-2	---	14-2	19-4
Gold-colored foil wrapped yarn	19-3	5-3	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---
Gold-colored foil laminate film	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	-5-1-	---	---	---	---	---	---
Aluminum-colored foil laminate film	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	5-1	19-1	5-1	---	---	---
Aluminum-colored foil wrapped yarn	---	---	---	---	19-3	5-3	---	---	---	---	---	19-3	5-3	---

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3.4.2.2 Core. The core for all classes of braid shall be a minimum of four (4) cotton stuffer yarns, sufficient to achieve the finished dimensions in 3.4.1. One determination per sample unit shall be made and the result reported as "actual count." Each stuffer yarn shall be a cord with four (4) to six (6) turns per inch in the final ply.

3.5 Weight. The finished cord-edge shall weigh 22 ounces to 25 ounces per 144 (gross) yards for all classes, when tested as specified below.

3.5.1 Weighing procedure. Two (2) lengths of cord-edge in excess of one (1) yard each shall be selected from each sample unit. The specimens shall then be measured (without stretching) and cut to exactly one (1) yard each. Samples shall be weighed using a calibrated balance or scale with an accuracy to 0.01 ounce. The weight of all one-yard specimens shall be averaged and then multiplied by 144 to determine ounces per 144 (gross) yards to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

3.6 Label. Each spool shall be labeled or ticketed for fiber content in accordance with Title 16 CFR Part 303, the Rules and Regulations under the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act.

3.7 Workmanship. The finished braid shall conform to the quality of product established by this document. The occurrence of defects (see Table V) shall not exceed the quality assurance limits as defined in the technical data in the bid package.

4 REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. Unless otherwise specified, the offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered, recycled, bio based, and environmentally preferable materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403, 23.404(b) of the Federal Acquisition Regulation FAR, or the sustainable acquisition of EO 13693; as applicable (see 7.1.3).

5 PRODUCT CONFORMANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Product conformance. The finished cord-edge braid provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Market acceptability. The cord-edge must have been sold to the government or the commercial market.

5.3 Inspection procedures. Sampling for inspection shall be conducted in accordance with ASQ/ANSI Z1.4 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection of Attributes (see 7.2.2).

5.4 Visual examination. The Finished cord-edge braid shall be examined for defects in Table V that are clearly noticeable at a normal inspection distance (3 feet). The material defects in Table V are as defined in ASTM D3990. Acceptance criteria shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order (see 7.6).

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TABLE V. Visual examination defects.

Cord section unevenly braided clearly visible at normal inspection distance of 3 feet
Any hole, cut or tear, any abrasion mark, spot or stain
Missing or broken yarn
Coarse or fine yarn
Braiding loose or tight clearly visible at normal inspection distance (3 feet)
Width of flat braid or cord cover section exceeding limits
Does not match referenced color, mottled or uneven color
Improperly or insecurely wound on spools, tangled and does not unwind properly
Any individual length less than five (5) yards
Total length more than two (2) yards more or less than the total length marked
Any spool containing more than three (3) individual pieces
Label missing, not securely attached, incorrect or illegible
Any braid not packaged in accordance with the contract or purchase order

5.5 Acceptance criteria. Acceptance criteria shall be as specified in the contract or procurement document (see 7.6).

6 PACKAGING The preservation, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 7.6).

7 NOTES

7.1 Sources of Government documents.

7.1.1 Copies of Government documents not otherwise specified here are available online at https://quicksearch.dla.mil.

7.1.2 Title 16 CFR Part 303, Rules and Regulations under the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act are available online at https://www.ecfr.gov/.

7.1.3 EPA and EO 13693 information is available online at https://www.epa.gov.

7.2 Sources for Non-Government documents.

7.2.1 AATCC test methods are available for purchase online at https://aatcc.org.

7.2.2 ASQ/ANSI Z1.4 – Sampling Procedures are available online at https://asq.org.

7.2.3 ASTM test methods are available for purchase online at https://www.astm.org.

7.2.4 Federal Acquisition Regulations (FAR) are available online at https://acquisition.gov.

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7.3 Intended use. This cord-edge is intended to be used in garrison caps used by the Army, the Air Force, and the Space Force for dress and service clothing items.

7.4 Standard samples. For access to standard shade samples of the cord-edge, address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids or request for proposal.

7.4.1 Visual shade matching. In 2017, Option A of AATCC EP9 was changed to Option C. NOTE: In case of confusion, the viewing geometry should be "The specimen plane and illumination source will be parallel to each other and aligned so that the light flux is incident at the center of the specimen plane, which is set at a 35 (± 5º) angle relative to the horizontal. The observer will view the specimens at a 90º angle, relative to the plane of the specimens."

7.4.2 In 2022, the U.S. Military (All Services) accepted D65 as the new preferred light source for visual shade matching due to the supply chain issues with D75.

7.4.3 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to previous issues due to the extensiveness of the changes.

7.5 Classes 12, 13 and 14 were added for the Space Force.

7.6 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this Commercial Item Description (CID)
b. Class(es) of cord-edge required (see 2.1)
c. Product conformance provisions (see 5.)
d. Acceptance criteria (see 5.4)
e. Packaging requirements (see 6.)

7.7 Key words.
Garrison Cap
Trim

MILITARY INTERESTS:

CIVIL COORDINATING AGENCYACTIVITY
GSA- FAS

Custodians:
Army – GL
Air Force – 11

Preparing activity:
DLA - CT

Review activity:
Army – IH, MD

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